Local-language recording brief: SPS awareness kit

Oct 28, 2026 · @Jonathan Obise

Version française : Français

At a glance

We need native speakers to translate and record short narration for our animated videos and radio capsules, in their own language. Please return your files by Nov 2, 2026, so we can build them into the sample kit before the bid closes on 6 November.

- **The project:** Paruto Media's bid to ARAA (the ECOWAS agency for agriculture and food) for awareness videos and radio on animal-health and food-safety rules in the West African livestock trade. The sample kit is live at https://media.paruto.com/araa-sps/.
- **Languages:** Hausa, Bambara, Wolof, Yoruba and Fulfulde (Fulani). One speaker or team per language.
- **What you start from:** each line in French, with English and Portuguese beside it, in a spreadsheet. Translate from the French.
- **Time involved:** about 2 minutes of finished narration per video and about 75 seconds per radio episode. Allow half a day per video, translation and checking included, and a short studio session.
- **Roles:** a translator, one or two voices, and a second speaker who checks the meaning. One person can be translator and voice.

Fees, credits and the use of your recordings are as agreed with Paruto Media before you start.

What you'll record

Start at the top and work down: if time runs short, the first two rows alone give the bid a complete sample in your language. Every line, with its time limit, is in the spreadsheet for that item on the recording kit page.

Priority	Item	Lines to record	Finished length	Voices	Spreadsheet
1	Radio episode 2: Crossing the border with a herd (ECOWAS)	9	about 70 s	Host and veterinarian	recording-capsules.csv
2	Video: Moussa's Journey (ECOWAS)	25	up to 2.0 min	One narrator	recording-ecowas.csv
3	Radio episode 1: International standards	10	about 80 s	Host and veterinarian	recording-capsules.csv
4	Radio episode 3: From herd to plate (WAEMU)	9	about 70 s	Host and veterinarian	recording-capsules.csv
5	Video: Aïcha's Market (international standards)	25	up to 2.3 min	One narrator	recording-international.csv
6	Video: Koffi's Butcher Shop (WAEMU)	25	up to 2.2 min	One narrator	recording-waemu.csv

Each video spreadsheet also lists the words shown on screen (buttons, quiz answers, labels). Translate those too, but don't record them.

Before any of this, agree the SPS terms in glossary.csv (step 1 below).

Step by step

1. **Agree the glossary.** Open glossary.csv and fill in your language's column for the 20 SPS terms (for example "certificat zoosanitaire international", "vétérinaire officiel", "traçabilité"). Send it to us first: we have it checked by an expert, so every line uses the same words.
2. **Translate.** In each spreadsheet, write your translation in your language's column (ha, bm, wo, yo or ff), line by line, from the French.
3. **Check.** A second speaker reads your translation back in French for the key lines (the regulations, the certificate, the quiz answers) and flags anything that has shifted in meaning.
4. **Time it.** Read each line aloud at a calm pace. It must fit the max_seconds column. If it doesn't, shorten the wording, never the pace.
5. **Record.** One file per line, named exactly as in the file column (see Naming and sending files).
6. **Send.** Return the completed spreadsheets and the audio files together.
7. **Review.** We build your recordings into the videos and capsules and send you a link to check before anything is published.

Translating

The goal is a line a herder, trader or butcher understands the first time they hear it, which matters more than a word-for-word match.

- **Meaning over words.** Say what the French says, in the way people in your area would say it. Keep the facts exactly: who does what, and what happens if they don't.
- **Add nothing.** No extra advice, examples or figures. These texts are checked by ARAA's experts, so a new claim would need new approval.
- **Fit the time.** max_seconds is the longest the spoken line can last, because it plays over a set scene. Shorter is fine; longer is not.
- **Names stay as they are:** Moussa, Aïcha, Koffi, and the show title's meaning, "Healthy Animals, Open Markets" (choose a natural way to say it and keep it the same in all three episodes).
- **Numbers stay exact:** "40 cattle" is 40 in every language.
- **SPS terms:** use the words agreed in the glossary, every time. Where your language has an established local name for a disease that herders use, prefer it and note it in the glossary.
- **Organisations and texts:** use the name people in your area already hear on radio. In francophone areas that is usually the French acronym (CEDEAO, UEMOA, OMC, OMSA, CIPV); in Nigeria and Ghana, the English one (ECOWAS, WTO). Read regulation numbers in full the same way, for example "Regulation 007 of 2007".
- **Unsure?** Add a note after your translation in square brackets, like [note: two possible words for "withdrawal period"]. We'd rather ask the expert than guess.

Voice direction

Sound like a trusted presenter on community radio: warm, calm and clear, speaking to one person, not a crowd. Never rushed and never salesy.

Voice	Used in	How it should sound
Narrator	The three videos	Friendly storyteller. Even pace, a little slower than conversation, with a short pause after each sentence. Questions to the viewer ("What should Moussa do?") sound like a real question.
Host	The radio episodes	Lively and welcoming. Opens and closes the show and asks the veterinarian short, curious questions.
Veterinarian	The radio episodes	Calm and reassuring, the voice of experience. Explains clearly, without lecturing.

- Host and veterinarian should be two clearly different voices; a woman and a man work well.
- Pronounce the glossary terms slowly and clearly the first time they appear in each episode.
- Keep the same voice for all the lines of one role.
- Record a natural reading, not a performance: no music, no sound effects, no added words.

Recording setup

A studio is best; a quiet room and a good USB microphone are fine. A phone is a last resort: use its voice-memo app in a small room full of soft furnishings, held 20 cm from the mouth.

Setting	What we need
Format	WAV, mono, 48 kHz, 24-bit (44.1 kHz 16-bit is also fine)
Room	Quiet and not echoey: curtains, cushions or a wardrobe of clothes around you help. Fans, air-conditioning and generators off.
Microphone	15 to 20 cm from the mouth, slightly to one side, with a pop filter if you have one
Level	Loud passages peak around −6 dB and never touch the red. No compression, effects or music.
Silence	About half a second of silence before and after each line

Setting	What we need
Takes	One clean take per line in the final file. Re-record a line rather than editing words together.

We level, clean and time the recordings here, so send them as recorded, without processing.

Naming and sending files

The file column of each spreadsheet gives the exact name and folder for every line. Replace `<lang>` with your language code and keep everything else, so each recording drops straight into place.

Language	Code	Example: video line	Example: radio line
Hausa	ha	videos/ecowas/rec/ha/meet-0.wav	audio/ecowas/rec/ha/01-host.wav
Bambara	bm	videos/ecowas/rec/bm/meet-0.wav	audio/ecowas/rec/bm/01-host.wav
Wolof	wo	videos/ecowas/rec/wo/meet-0.wav	audio/ecowas/rec/wo/01-host.wav
Yoruba	yo	videos/ecowas/rec/yo/meet-0.wav	audio/ecowas/rec/yo/01-host.wav
Fulfulde	ff	videos/ecowas/rec/ff/meet-0.wav	audio/ecowas/rec/ff/01-host.wav

- In the radio files, the number is the line's order in the episode and the word is the role: `01-host`, `03-vet`, and the credit last (`10-credit` in episode 1, `09-credit` in episodes 2 and 3).
- Lower case, no spaces, nothing added to the names (no "final" or "v2").
- Put the folders and the completed spreadsheets in one zip named `sps-<code>-<your-name>.zip`, for example `sps-ha-amina.zip`.
- Send it through a file-transfer link (WeTransfer or Google Drive) to the Paruto Media coordinator who sent you this brief. Email attachments are usually too large.

Checklist before you send

- [ ] Glossary column filled in and sent to Paruto Media first
- [ ] Every line translated in your language's column, with notes in [square brackets] where unsure

- [ ] On-screen texts translated (the second part of each video spreadsheet)
- [ ] Key lines checked by a second speaker
- [ ] Every line read aloud within its max_seconds
- [ ] One WAV per line, named exactly as in the file column, with your language code
- [ ] Host and veterinarian recorded by two different voices
- [ ] No music, effects or processing; half a second of silence at each end
- [ ] Everything zipped as sps-<code>-<your-name>.zip and sent by Nov 2, 2026
- [ ] The name you'd like in the credits, and each voice's agreement to how the recordings are used, sent with the files